

SPaG, Comprehension & Maths — Full Checklist

Expanded version of the recap checklist — same "have we covered this" tick-box format, much deeper coverage per topic. Pair with **spag-comprehension-practice-pack.pdf** for actual practice questions on each item below.

1 SPELLING

Rule-based categories

- ☐ **i before e** (believe, receive, ceiling — and the exceptions: weird, seize, either)
except after c
- ☐ **Doubling the final consonant** before -ing/-ed on short-vowel words (running, stopped, but NOT raining/cooked)
- ☐ **Silent letters** (knight, thumb, science, autumn)
- ☐ **-able vs -ible** (comfortable, reliable vs. possible, visible — no reliable single rule, learn by list)
- ☐ **-tion / -sion / -cian** endings (action, occasion, musician)
- ☐ **Prefixes that don't double the letter** (disappoint not dissappoint, misspell IS double because mis+spell)

Homophones to know cold

there/their/they're · its/it's · your/you're · whose/who's ·
to/too/two · affect/effect · practice/practise ·
stationary/stationery · principal/principle · weather/whether

High-frequency 11+ trap words

necessary · definitely · separate · occasion · privilege ·
embarrass · accommodate · government · existence ·
consistent · recommend · pursue · rhythm · conscious ·
questionnaire · immediately · parliament · vegetable ·
Wednesday · February

Exam technique

- ☐ Segment format: sentence split into 4 parts — mark which contains the error, or mark N
- ☐ Read the FULL sentence first, not just each segment in isolation
- ☐ Don't assume every sentence has a mistake — genuinely correct sentences appear too
- ☐ Say the word aloud in your head, syllable by syllable, if unsure

2 PUNCTUATION

Every mark, checked off

- ☐ **Full stop** — ends a complete sentence
- ☐ **Comma** — lists, joining clauses with a conjunction, around interrupting phrases
- ☐ **Comma splice** — spot two main clauses wrongly joined by just a comma ("It rained, we stayed in." → needs ; or a conjunction)
- ☐ **Apostrophe — single possession** (Elsa's bike)
- ☐ **Apostrophe — plural possession** (the students' books)
- ☐ **Apostrophe — joint possession** (Sam and Priya's project — one shared thing)
- ☐ **Apostrophe — separate possession** (Sam's and Priya's essays — two separate things)
- ☐ **Apostrophe — contraction vs. possessive pronoun** (it's = it is, its = belonging to it)

- ☐ **Semicolon** — joins two related main clauses with NO conjunction (not before "but"/"yet")
- ☐ **Colon** — introduces a list or an explanation
- ☐ **Hyphen** — compound numbers 21-99, compound adjectives before a noun (twenty-one, a well-known author)
- ☐ **Quotation marks** — direct/verbatim speech only, never for reported/paraphrased speech
- ☐ **Brackets/dashes** — extra, removable information
- ☐ **Ellipsis** — trailing off, or an omission
- ☐ **Question/exclamation marks** — never doubled up with a full stop

Exam technique

- ☐ Same segment format as spelling — one error type per real exam, rotate through categories
- ☐ Long, multi-clause sentences hide errors best — read slowly, don't skim
- ☐ N (no mistake) is a genuine, real answer — don't be afraid to pick it

Word classes — can you identify each?

- ☐ Noun / Pronoun
- ☐ Verb (and tense: past/present/future, simple/continuous/perfect)
- ☐ Adjective / Adverb
- ☐ Preposition
- ☐ Conjunction (coordinating: and/but/or — subordinating: although/because/since)
- ☐ Determiner

Sentence & clause types

- ☐ Simple sentence (one main clause)
- ☐ Compound sentence (two main clauses + and/but/or/so)
- ☐ Complex sentence (main clause + subordinate clause)
- ☐ Relative clause (who/which/that/whose)
- ☐ Non-finite/participial clause (-ing or -ed opening, no subject)

Common error checklist

- ☐ Subject-verb agreement ("The list of names WAS long" — not "were")
- ☐ Tense consistency across a passage/sentence
- ☐ Dangling/misplaced modifiers ("Running late, the bus was missed" → who was running?)
- ☐ Pronoun case (I vs. me, who vs. whom)
- ☐ Double negatives ("I don't know nothing" → wrong)
- ☐ Comparative/superlative (more worse → worse; bestest → best)
- ☐ Parallel structure in lists ("I like running, swimming, and to cycle" → to cycle should be cycling)
- ☐ fewer (countable) vs. less (uncountable)

Connectives by function

FUNCTION	EXAMPLES
Cause	because, since, as, given that
Contrast	although, whereas, despite, however
Addition	furthermore, moreover, also
Condition	if, unless, provided that
Time	meanwhile, before, once, as soon as

Cloze technique (fill-the-gap, one word per blank)

- ☐ Read the whole sentence — before AND after the gap — before choosing
- ☐ Every option is usually grammatically valid alone — only context picks the right one
- ☐ Check tense agreement with the rest of the sentence/passage
- ☐ Check the connective logic (cause/contrast/condition — see table above)
- ☐ Re-read the completed sentence aloud in your head to confirm it flows

4 COMPREHENSION

Reading strategy

- ☐ Read the whole passage once for gist before any question
- ☐ Underline/note names, places, and repeated words
- ☐ Mark paragraph numbers as you read — questions reference them directly
- ☐ Re-read only the relevant paragraph(s) per question, don't rely on memory
- ☐ Answer using the passage's own evidence, not outside knowledge

Question-type checklist

- ☐ **Retrieval** — exact match; distractors are real details from elsewhere in the text
- ☐ **Inference** — combine 2+ nearby clues; ask "what does this show, not just say?"
- ☐ **Vocabulary-in-context** — check the word's specific sense in THAT sentence, not its everyday meaning
- ☐ **Grammar-embedded** — word class/clause questions using words lifted from the passage itself
- ☐ **Literary technique** — name the device in a quoted fragment
- ☐ **NOT-questions** — check all 4 options against the text one at a time; 3 are true, 1 isn't mentioned
- ☐ **Character/author "voice"** — think about tone across the WHOLE passage, not one line

Three layers — Character & Setting

Character — Physical

appearance, what we see

Setting — Physical

concrete detail

Character — Emotional

feelings, inner thought

Setting — Sensory/Imagery

sounds, smells, textures

Character — Behavioural

actions, what they do/say

Setting — Atmosphere

mood the reader feels

- ☐ **Show, not Tell** — replace a flat statement ("she was sad") with action/sensory detail (hands trembled, looked away)
- ☐ Build description one layer at a time rather than dumping all three at once

Literary techniques — full glossary

- ☐ **Simile** — compares using like/as
- ☐ **Metaphor** — states one thing IS another
- ☐ **Extended metaphor** — a metaphor developed across several lines/paragraphs
- ☐ **Personification** — human qualities given to something non-human
- ☐ **Imagery** — descriptive language appealing to the senses
- ☐ **Symbolism** — an object represents a bigger idea
- ☐ **Foreshadowing** — an early hint of what happens later
- ☐ **Alliteration** — repeated consonant sound
- ☐ **Onomatopoeia** — word that sounds like its meaning
- ☐ **Hyperbole** — deliberate exaggeration
- ☐ **Repetition** — for emphasis
- ☐ **Juxtaposition** — two contrasting things placed side by side
- ☐ **Pathetic fallacy** — weather/nature reflects mood
- ☐ **Rhetorical question** — asked for effect, not a real answer

Arithmetic & number

- ☐ BIDMAS order of operations
- ☐ Negative number arithmetic
- ☐ Rounding to significant figures/decimal places
- ☐ Factors, multiples, HCF, LCM
- ☐ Squares, cubes, roots
- ☐ Estimation

Fractions, decimals, percentages

- ☐ Converting between all three forms
- ☐ Adding/subtracting fractions with different denominators
- ☐ Percentage increase/decrease
- ☐ Reverse percentage problems
- ☐ Fraction of a remaining amount (sequential)

Ratio & proportion

- ☐ Simplifying a ratio
- ☐ Sharing an amount in a given ratio
- ☐ Direct vs. inverse proportion
- ☐ Map scale problems

Algebra

- ☐ Solving equations with x on both sides
- ☐ Expanding brackets
- ☐ Forming an equation from a word problem
- ☐ Sequences — nth term, differences
- ☐ Substitution (including negatives)

Geometry

- ☐ Angles at a point / in a triangle / in a polygon
- ☐ Area and perimeter of compound shapes
- ☐ Circumference and area of a circle
- ☐ Volume of a cuboid
- ☐ Reflection, rotation, translation

Statistics

- ☐ Mean, median, mode, range
- ☐ Reading bar charts, line graphs, pie charts
- ☐ Simple and combined probability
- ☐ Venn diagrams